

Syed Zafar Abbas Naqvi

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Objective

Operations and education leader with expertise in managing large teams, P&L, and scalable processes, seeking to drive operational excellence, stakeholder alignment, and high-impact outcomes in a global, growth-focused organization.

Experience

• Unacademy

June 2025 - Till date

Operations Head - Academics & Administration

Responsibilities & Achievements:

Led and managed large-scale operations, overseeing end-to-end delivery and performance of cross-functional teams, ensuring high-quality and timely execution of all tasks.

Supervised daily operational activities, driving efficiency, process adherence, and seamless functioning of the center.

Collaborated with HQ stakeholders and cross-geography teams to align processes, standardize workflows, and implement best practices.

Drove continuous process improvement initiatives, including development and implementation of SOPs, enhancing productivity and operational efficiency.

Ensured strict adherence to organizational policies, compliance standards, and operational integrity across all functions.

Mentored and coached team members and supervisors, fostering professional growth, leadership development, and high team engagement.

Prepared and presented operational reports, dashboards, and performance insights for leadership and stakeholders.

Supported financial planning activities including budgeting, cost optimization, resource allocation, and tracking of operational expenses.

Identified operational risks, implemented mitigation strategies, and drove continuous improvement initiatives.

Administration, Vendor & Facility Management

Managed end-to-end office administration and facility operations to ensure business continuity and workplace efficiency.

Oversaw vendor management, procurement processes, AMC services, housekeeping, and security operations, ensuring SLA compliance.

Handled lease agreements, property coordination, and stakeholder communication for facility-related matters.

Supervised infrastructure maintenance, repairs, workplace safety, and asset management.

Managed telecommunication systems, IT vendor coordination, and ensured uninterrupted internet and system services.

Monitored inventory, office supplies, and procurement activities, maintaining optimal stock levels and cost control.

Ensured timely processing of utility payments and maintained accurate documentation for audits and compliance.

Team Leadership & Development

Built and led high-performing teams, fostering a collaborative, accountable, and performance-driven work culture.

Set clear performance goals, KPIs, and expectations aligned with organizational objectives.

Conducted regular team meetings, performance reviews, and feedback sessions to ensure alignment and continuous improvement.

- **Lissun - Mental Health Startup**

Sept 2023 - May 2025

Category Lead - Education Ops & Strategy

Function: Strategy | Operations | Partnerships | Leadership & Business Management

Led and scaled large-scale operations and program delivery, managing cross-functional teams and ensuring high-quality, timely execution across multiple regions.

Built and expanded the Mental Health in Education vertical from 0 to 1, driving strategy, operations setup, partnerships, and execution across Rajasthan (Sikar, Kota, Jaipur).

Managed end-to-end business operations including P&L ownership, cost optimization, resource planning, and financial performance tracking.

Supervised day-to-day operational activities, ensuring process adherence, service quality, and alignment with organizational goals and compliance standards.

Collaborated with senior leadership and cross-functional/global stakeholders to align processes, drive best practices, and ensure seamless execution.

Designed and implemented SOPs, process frameworks, and efficiency initiatives, improving operational effectiveness and scalability.

Built, mentored, and managed high-performing teams (including psychologists, operational staff, and managers), fostering leadership development and strong team engagement.

Established and managed strategic partnerships with leading education institutes, enabling large-scale program delivery and long-term collaborations.

Delivered structured programs including QPR (Question, Persuade, Refer) and Behavior Change Communication (BCC) training, group/individual counseling, and psychological assessments.

Prepared and presented business reviews, dashboards, operational insights, and performance reports to leadership and key stakeholders.

Identified operational risks, implemented mitigation strategies, and drove continuous improvement initiatives across regions.

Operations, Administration & Vendor Management:

Managed end-to-end administrative and facility operations, ensuring business continuity and efficient workplace management.

Led vendor management, procurement, and commercial negotiations, ensuring cost efficiency and SLA adherence.

Oversaw infrastructure, facility maintenance, asset tracking, and workplace safety standards.

Ensured compliance with organizational policies, audit requirements, and documentation standards.

Key Achievements:

Built and scaled a new business vertical from inception into a revenue-generating, multi-city operation. Managed and led large, multi-disciplinary teams, driving performance, engagement, and service quality.

Established partnerships with top-tier institutes (CLC, Gurukripa, DS Institute, PW, Resonance, Motion, Unacademy), significantly expanding market presence.

Successfully integrated mental health programs into mainstream education ecosystems, positioning them as a core institutional offering.

Improved operational efficiency through process optimization, structured governance, and scalable delivery models.

- **Physics Wallah**

Sept 2022 - Sept 2023

Regional Manager - Operations Excellence

Responsibilities: Regional Operations Lead (Academic Operations & Business Management)

Led and managed end-to-end operations across 5 strategic centres in North India, ensuring alignment with organizational objectives, quality standards, and regional growth targets.

Directed Academic Operations (AcadOps), overseeing curriculum delivery, faculty performance, student outcomes, and classroom excellence across multiple centres.

Managed full P&L ownership, including revenue optimization, budgeting, forecasting, cost control, and resource allocation to drive financial performance.

Supervised day-to-day operations, ensuring high-quality and timely execution, adherence to SOPs, and operational consistency across all locations.

Designed and implemented process improvement initiatives, compliance frameworks, audit mechanisms, and performance benchmarks to enhance efficiency and scalability.

Led and mentored large, multi-functional teams including centre heads, academic leaders, counsellors, and operations staff; drove hiring, training, performance management, and leadership development.

Collaborated with cross-functional teams (Marketing, HR, Finance, Product) to align strategies, optimize operations, and support business expansion.

Developed and executed strategies for student acquisition, retention, and market positioning, strengthening competitive advantage in the education segment.

Built and maintained data-driven dashboards and MIS reporting systems, providing actionable insights to leadership and enabling informed decision-making.

Ensured compliance with academic integrity, operational policies, and organizational standards across all centres.

Identified operational risks and implemented mitigation strategies to ensure business continuity and service quality.

Represented the organization in stakeholder engagements, partnerships, and community initiatives, enhancing brand visibility and institutional relationships.

Key Achievements:

Successfully managed multi-location operations at scale, ensuring consistent quality and performance across all centres.

Improved operational efficiency through standardized SOPs, performance tracking, and process optimization initiatives.

Strengthened financial performance through effective P&L management and cost optimization strategies.

Built and developed high-performing leadership teams, improving overall productivity and operational excellence.

Enhanced student experience and academic outcomes, contributing to strong satisfaction levels and retention metrics.

• **ExtraMark's Education India Pvt Ltd**

Nov 2020 - Sept 2022

Educator

Key Responsibilities:

- Teach Chemistry K-10 students, tailoring lessons to meet diverse learning needs and ensuring comprehensive understanding of the subjects.

- Conduct doubt sessions for overseas students, providing additional support to address their specific challenges.

- Mentor and motivate students in their studies and career aspirations, offering guidance and encouragement.

- Ensure results assurance for assigned student batches, monitoring academic progress and implementing strategies to improve performance.

- Lead a team of mentors, including hiring and training new mentors as needed.

- Coordinate with senior management to provide updates on academic strategies and feedback, contributing to the development and refinement of academic programs.

Education

- **GI Bajaj institute of Technology & Management**
B.tech
- **Oriental College**
Intermediate in Science - Mathematics's
- **Scholars Abode**
Matriculations

Skills

- 1. G-SHEET & EXCEL 2. Communication Skills 3. Academic planning & Team Building 4. GTM Strategy 5. Operations Excellence 6. Jira software for Project Management 7. Digital Marketing

Projects

- **Project**
Utilisation of waste saw dust as reinforcement in Development of Glass Fiber Epoxy Composite to enhance Mechanical Properties and to reduce Environmental Pollution.

Achievements & Awards

- Invited as a Motivational Speaker from coaching federation of India and some coaching classes, Schools & Corporate's. I also invited paid as Chief Guest from Engineering & Environmental Solutions Pvt.Ltd at Aligarh on Annual General Meeting to Motivate employee's

Activities

- 1.Teaching and Motivating Underserved Students: Educating and inspiring financially disadvantaged students and children from slum areas, raising awareness about educational opportunities and challenges. 2.Cycling: Passionate about cycling, enjoying both recreational rides and exploring new routes. 3. Watching Web Series:Enthusiastic about watching web series, keeping up with the latest trends in digital entertainment. 4. Volunteering with NGOs: Actively participating in various non-governmental organizations, dedicating time to support community-focused initiatives and charitable activities.

Languages

- English| Hindi| Urdu| Bhojpuri

I hereby declare that all the information given above is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.